

Latvian Roundwood Trade Buyers Suppliers and Export Practice

Executive summary

Latvia remains one of the EU's most timber-intensive economies. The latest directly visible official forestry production figure in the Ministry of Agriculture's *Latvian Forest Sector in Facts & Figures 2025* shows **15.05 million m³** of timber production in **2023**, split almost evenly between **state forests (7.2 million m³)** and **other forests (7.85 million m³)**. The same publication also states that Latvia's forest area is about **3.45 million hectares**, roughly **53%** of national territory, and that the state owns around half of the forests while the rest belongs to about **135,000 private forest owners**. In **2024**, state forest manager **AS Latvijas valsts meži** reported a **record 7.44 million m³** of delivered roundwood assortments, confirming that LVM remains the single most important supplier to Latvia's domestic processors and export traders. ¹

On the buying side, the Latvian market is best understood as three overlapping channels. The first is **domestic industrial processors** such as **Latvijas Finieris**, **Stiga RM**, and **Vika Wood**, which buy veneer logs and sawlogs under published diameter-and-grade grids. The second is **port-based pulpwood/export buyers** such as **ACA Timber**, **Laskana**, and **Sōdra Mežs**, which buy at Riga, Ventspils, Skulte, Liepāja, and Roja for onward shipment. The third is **integrated traders and forest buyers** such as **BONO** and **PATA**, which buy standing timber, roadside wood, and small-trader lots, then resell into mills or export channels. Publicly visible purchasing rules show that independent measurement via **VMF Latvia**, strict assortment specifications, and payment terms ranging from **2 business days to 30 days** are standard commercial levers. ²

Export practice is highly port-centric. Public terminal data show substantial dedicated timber-handling capacity at **Ventspils** and **Riga**, with Skulte and Liepāja/Roja functioning as important niche pulpwood/export points. The core short-sea destination system is **Sweden-Finland**, while **China** remains a large long-haul roundwood outlet by value. Among the major partner-country pages retrievable from UN Comtrade-based public sources for **2025**, Latvian *wood in the rough* exports were largest to **Sweden**, **China**, and **Finland**. UK trade is very important for Latvia's wider wood sector, but in the open sources reviewed here it is primarily a **processed-wood** destination rather than a named major roundwood buyer. ³

For regulation, the key shift is from the old **EU Timber Regulation** regime to the newer **EU Deforestation Regulation** framework applying to wood. EUR-Lex confirms that Regulation (EU) **2023/1115** covers **wood** and **exports from the Union** and repeals Regulation (EU) **No 995/2010**; after successive postponements, the newest public EUR-Lex summary points to application from **30 December 2026** for non-micro/non-small operators and **30 June 2027** for micro and small enterprises. For trade with non-EU destinations, Latvia's **State Plant Protection Service** states that a **phytosanitary certificate** is required for export of regulated plant products to third countries, requests should be filed **no later than 48 hours before export**, and wood packaging must comply with **ISPM 15**. ⁴

The main operational conclusion for a new exporter is straightforward: the fastest route into the market is **not** to start with anonymous spot cargoes, but to secure one reliable upstream fibre source, one

independent measurement workflow, and one downstream port or mill offtake line. The public record strongly suggests that counterparties reward **predictability, documentation quality, and spec discipline** more than headline price alone. ⁵

Market size and trade balance

The most important statistical limitation is this: the official Ministry of Agriculture / CSB tables **MEK010** and **MEK020** are publicly indexed as updated through **2024**, but in this session the row-level **2024 annual roundwood totals** for production/imports/exports could not be extracted from the PxWeb interface without direct API execution. I therefore use the **latest directly visible primary-source values** and label the remaining gaps explicitly. The table metadata themselves confirm that **MEK010** covers *production, exports and imports of wood products 2017–2024* and **MEK020** covers *wood exports and imports value 2017–2024*. ⁶

Verified headline figures

Metric	Latest year directly evidenced in this session	Figure	Basis	Comment
Timber production, Latvia total	2023	15.05 million m³	official forestry factsbook	Total timber production by ownership. ⁷
State-forest timber production	2023	7.20 million m³	official forestry factsbook	Proxy for state-supply weight in the market. ⁷
Other-forest timber production	2023	7.85 million m³	official forestry factsbook	Proxy for private/cooperative/logging-contractor supply. ⁷
LVM delivered roundwood assortments to processors	2024	7.44 million m³	LVM operating result	Record level; not identical to national production, but the best direct 2024 supplier-side reference visible here. ⁸
Forest-sector roundwood import value	2023	EUR 110 million	Ministry factsbook import chart	Read directly from the “Forest Sector import development” chart; roundwood segment for 2023. ⁹
National exports of all goods	2024	EUR 18.68 billion	CSB	Wider macro context. ¹⁰
National imports of all goods	2024	EUR 21.68 billion	CSB	Wider macro context. ¹⁰

Metric	Latest year directly evidenced in this session	Figure	Basis	Comment
National exports of all goods	2025	EUR 19.54 billion	CSB/Latvian Public Media summary of CSB data	Wider macro context. ¹¹
Final consumption of firewood	2024	2.509 million m³ solid	CSB energy table	Energy wood, not industrial roundwood. Useful only as the best visible official domestic-consumption data for woodfuel. ¹²
Final consumption of wood chips	2024	2.489 million m³ loose	CSB energy table	Energy wood, not industrial roundwood. ¹²
Final consumption of wood waste	2024	3.406 million m³ loose	CSB energy table	Energy wood, not industrial roundwood. ¹²

Data-gap statement. I did **not** reproduce uncited 2024 annual national roundwood production/import/export totals from MEK010/MEK020 because the session exposed only table metadata, not the selected result rows. For industrial roundwood **domestic consumption**, I therefore cannot give a robust annual 2024 national total without inventing one. The only directly visible official wood-consumption numbers in this session are the **fuelwood/energy-wood** balance figures above. ¹³

Latvia timber production by ownership, 2023

Chart based on the Ministry of Agriculture's 2025 forest-sector factsbook, which shows 2023 timber production of 7.2 million m³ in state forests and 7.85 million m³ in other forests. ⁷

What these numbers imply

The single cleanest inference from the official production chart is that **Latvian roundwood supply is structurally dual-sourced**: about half comes from the **state-managed LVM/VMD system**, and about half comes from **private owners and non-state forests**. In practice that means a new exporter must master **two procurement languages**: formal, highly standardised contracting on the state side, and fragmented relationship-driven roadside and standing-timber deals on the private side. ¹⁴

Buyer landscape

Domestic processors, traders and foreign offtake lines

The most commercially relevant buyers are the companies that either publish procurement rules or clearly disclose offtake points. Public evidence shows a strong split between **processor buyers** and **port buyers**.

Buyer	Role in roundwood chain	Country of origin / ownership	Public scale indicator	Main assortments	Pricing / measurement / terms visible in public sources	Public contact
Latvijas Finieris	Veneer-log buyer; birch plywood processor	Latvia	Multi-yard procurement footprint across Latvia and Baltics; sources only within the EU since 2021	Birch veneer logs; some birch pulpwood	Diameter-based lot pricing by yard; PEFC premium + EUR 1.50/m³ ; independent measurement; VMF Latvia photo/group methods; whole load may be rejected if >10% non-conforming; copies of property/ felling/timber valuation documents required for some offers.	Uvis Dūdiņš, +371 26 164 0000 , uvis.dudins@finieris.lv ; or Bauskas iela 59, Rīga. 16

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Buyer	Role in roundwood chain	Country of origin / ownership	Public scale indicator	Main assortments	Pricing / measurement / terms visible in public sources	Public contact
Stiga RM	Veneer-log and forest-property buyer; integrated processor	Latvia	500+ staff across group companies	Birch veneer logs; roundwood; forest properties and felling sites	Published veneer-log buying grid; at Kuldīga, payment is published as within 2 business days after measuring; for deliveries without prior contracts, payment is published as 30 days from 01.03.2026; quality and measurement windows explicitly stated. ¹⁷	Office +371 26663393, birojs@stigarm.lv; veneer buying +371 26661154, finierkluci@stigarm.lv.
Vika Wood	Large sawmill buying softwood sawlogs	Latvia; since 2025 part of HS Timber Group Austria	Produces about 280,000 m³ of softwood sawn timber annually; over EUR 80 million turnover; about 140 employees	Spruce and pine sawlogs	Published diameter/ length price sheets for spruce and pine sawlogs; requires copy of felling permit and origin documents; fresh-cut requirement stated; FSC/ PEFC held by company. ¹⁹	Yard contact +371 2644333, andra.muceniece@vikawood.lv; main office +371 63291800

Buyer	Role in roundwood chain	Country of origin / ownership	Public scale indicator	Main assortments	Pricing / measurement / terms visible in public sources	Public contact
PATA	Integrated forest manager, trader and raw-material buyer	Latvia	Broad advisory-centre network; active in management, property and raw-material buying	Timber materials, forest properties, felling areas, fuelwood	Publicly offers forest-owner financing and named raw-material buyers; commercial model indicates aggregator/trader role between small suppliers and larger mills/export users. 21	Timber purchasing: Ivo Šveders +371 26515503, ivo.sveders@pata.lv ; Juris Gribusts +371 22414200, juris.gribusts@pata.lv . 22
BONO	Large trader / integrated forestry and logistics group	Latvia	Management states group turnover has exceeded EUR 100 million ; registry-based 2024 net sales for SIA BONO alone EUR 56.8 million	Roundwood, forest resources, energy wood, export lots	Commercial emphasis on financing, logistics and export-market development; public advance programme offers 100% advance for log purchases, repayable with wood deliveries within 60 days . 22	Group: +371 28096888, info@bonotimber.com ; R office Ūnijas iela 8 k-7. 23

Buyer	Role in roundwood chain	Country of origin / ownership	Public scale indicator	Main assortments	Pricing / measurement / terms visible in public sources	Public contact
ACA Timber	Port pulpwood/ export buyer	Latvia	Active in Riga, Ventspils, Skulte, Mērsrags, Liepāja	Birch pulpwood, aspen pulpwood, coniferous pulpwood, firewood, chips	Public port-by-port procurement pages; pricing posted by assortment; payment within 5 working days ; port delivery model strongly suited to exporters and Scandinavian pulpwood chains. ²⁴	Riga/Ventspils: +371 26688 matiss@acatimber.lv ; Skulte: +371 29484140, skulte@acatimber.lv . ²⁴
Laskana	Port pulpwood/ firewood buyer and exporter	Latvia	Active procurement in Liepāja, Roja, Riga ports	Coniferous pulpwood, birch pulpwood, aspen pulpwood, firewood, chips	Publishes port price grids; explicitly buys FSC-certified roundwood; requires new suppliers to sign a Supplier Declaration and provide origin information. ²⁵	Certification contact lelde@laskana.lv ; location and working hours published for all ports. ²⁵

Buyer	Role in roundwood chain	Country of origin / ownership	Public scale indicator	Main assortments	Pricing / measurement / terms visible in public sources	Public contact
Södra Mežs	Foreign-linked pulpwood export buyer	Latvia / Sweden	Södra states Baltic activity now includes two import companies, one in Latvia and one in Estonia	Birch pulpwood, softwood pulpwood, aspen pulpwood	At Skulte, price is stated as according to individual agreement ; independent measurement by VMF Latvia ; designed for export flows. Södra also states its Swedish mills may source small volumes from Latvia and other Baltic States. ²⁶	+371 29503444 , ieva.lace@sodra.com , Skulte, iela 1, Zvejniekciems / office, Aristida Briāna iela 9A-2, Rīga ²⁷
Metsä-linked offtake via ACA / former Metsä Forest Latvia	Finnish pulpwood channel	Finland / Latvia	Metsä confirmed sale of Latvian wood-supply business to ACA Timber with long-term deliveries of pulpwood and chips to Metsä Group	Pulpwood and chips	Strong evidence that Finnish pulp producers remain an important export sink for Latvian fibre, even if the local buying platform shifted from Metsä Forest Latvia to ACA Timber. ²⁸	Buyer interface now appears to be run via ACA Timber's public contacts. ²⁴

Analytical read on buyer concentration

The buyer landscape is **concentrated but not closed**. Birch high-value material is channelled disproportionately into **Latvijas Finieris** and **Stiga RM**. Softwood sawlogs go to **Vika Wood** and other sawmills, while pulpwood and lower-value assortments have a broader outlet set via **ACA Timber**, **Laskana**, and **Södra Mežs**. For a new exporter, the practical lesson is that **assortment flexibility matters more than absolute size**: buyers with port outlets can keep moving mixed pulpwood and firewood even when domestic veneer or sawlog demand tightens. ²⁹

Market-share estimates

A precise buyer-by-buyer Latvian roundwood market-share table is **not publicly available** in the sources reviewed. What can be supported is a **segment view**:

- **LVM/state side** represents roughly **48%** of national timber production by ownership in the latest directly visible official chart for 2023. ⁷
- In birch veneer logs, **Latvijas Finieris** and **Stiga RM** are clearly among the dominant named domestic buyers because both publish dedicated veneer-log procurement rules and multi-site intake points. ³⁰
- In softwood sawlogs, **Vika Wood** is one of the largest visible named buyers among public sawlog sheets, supported by its published output of **280,000 m³** of sawn timber. ³¹
- In pulpwood export yards, **ACA Timber**, **Laskana**, and **Södra Mežs** are the clearest publicly contactable channels. ³²

Supplier landscape and commercial practice

Who supplies the market

Supplier class	Commercial importance	Public evidence	Indicative market share / weight	Public contact / route
AS Latvijas valsts meži	Dominant organised supplier of state wood	LVM delivered 7.44 million m³ of roundwood assortments in 2024; Ministry factsbook shows state forests produced 7.2 million m³ in 2023	Roughly half of Latvian timber production by ownership in latest visible official chart	Main contact lvm@lvm.lv, +371 67610015 , Vairodes iela 1, Rīga. ³³
Private forest owners	Essential fragmented supplier base	Ministry factsbook says the non-state forest estate belongs to around 135,000 private forest owners	Roughly the other half of supply by ownership in 2023 chart	Usually accessed via traders, buyers' forest-procurement teams, owner associations. ³⁴
Logging contractors / harvesters / transporters	Operational bridge between forest and buyer	Stiga RM and PATA both publish separate forest-property, harvesting and transport functions; BONO and ACA emphasise logistics integration	No public national market-share data found	Named procurement/transport contacts on Stiga RM, PATA, BONO, ACA pages. ³⁵

How roadside purchases work in practice

The public buyer pages are remarkably consistent on one point: **roadside business is document-heavy and specification-driven**. Latvijas Finieris explicitly says that offer evaluation may require copies of

property, felling, and timber valuation documents, and that quality is verified by independent measurement systems. Vika Wood requires that, in addition to the transport note, sellers attach a **copy of the felling permit** and **origin documents** when delivering sawlogs. Laskana requires a signed **Supplier Declaration** and origin information from new suppliers. This makes the practical Latvian norm clear: even where the commercial relationship is informal, the **document trail is not**. ³⁶

Publicly visible payment terms also show how sellers think about cash flow. Stiga RM publishes **2 business days after measuring** for ordinary veneer-log buying, but **30 days** for certain non-contracted deliveries. ACA Timber publishes **5 working days** after port deliveries. BONO's advance programme offers **100% advance** against later wood delivery. That combination suggests a realistic market expectation: small suppliers and forest owners usually prefer **very fast money**, and some intermediaries compete explicitly on financing speed, but mills and port buyers stretch timing when a load is **spot, uncontracted, or higher risk**. ³⁷

Standing-timber and forest-property purchases

Standing timber and felling-site purchases are not a side business; they are a mainstream procurement route. Latvijas Finieris, Stiga RM, and PATA all publish dedicated pages or contact teams for **felling sites** and **forest properties**. That implies that many suppliers do **not** bring assortments to roadside first; instead, they sell rights to harvest, with the buyer taking on cutting, logistics, sorting, and downstream placement risk. BONO and PATA also publish forest-owner financing products, which is a strong signal that owner liquidity needs and transaction simplicity are commercially important in winning supply. ³⁸

What is clearly documented, and what is not

The open-source record clearly documents the following as **typical**:

- published **diameter-based** price grids for veneer logs and sawlogs; ³⁹
- independent measurement by **VMF Latvia** or line-based automated measurement; ⁴⁰
- load rejection or repricing risk when quality is materially off-spec; ⁴¹
- importance of certification declarations and origin proofs. ⁴²

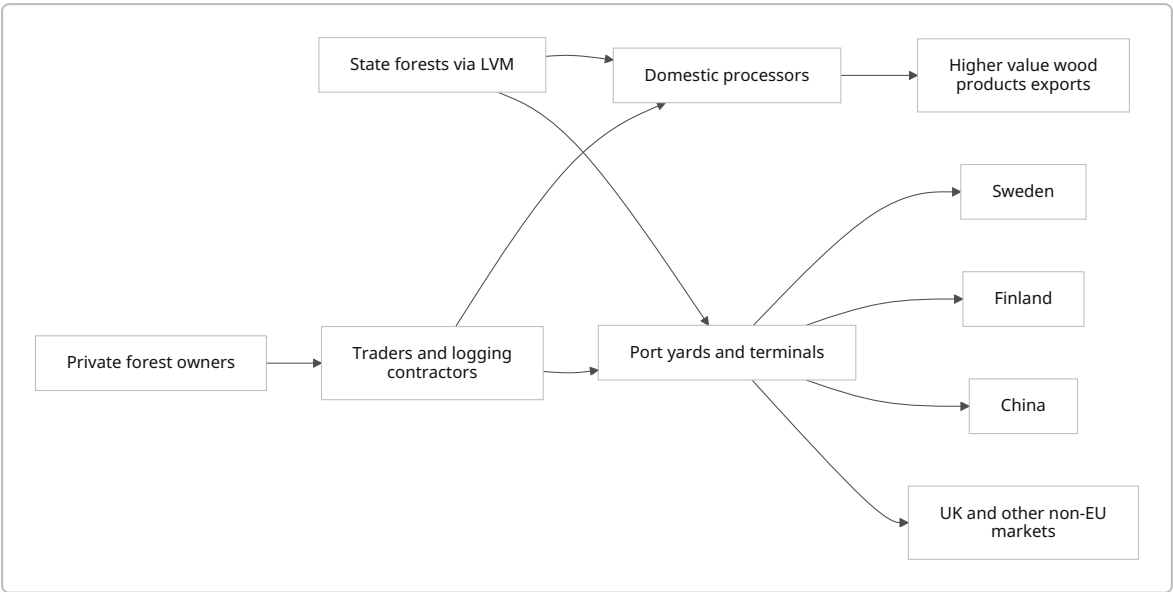
The following remain **partly opaque in public sources** and should be treated as interview topics rather than public fact:

- exact broker commissions on roadside or standing-timber deals;
- how often verbal agreements are used before written confirmation;
- frequency of buyer insolvency in the Latvian roundwood segment specifically;
- whether yards deliberately “shave” diameter at bracket thresholds;
- how often seasonal overstock leads to softer or harsher grading rather than formal purchase stops.

Those are not safe to quantify from the public record reviewed here.

Export routes ports and operational requirements

Flow structure



The export chain is visibly organised around a handful of Baltic short-sea and port-delivery formats rather than long inland rail systems. ACA Timber’s published buying network across **Riga, Ventspils, Skulte, Mērsrags, and Liepāja**, Laskana’s active buying at **Liepāja, Roja, and Riga**, and Sōdra Mežs’ Skulte export yard together show how Latvian roundwood export practice works in reality: wood is aggregated inland, then redirected either to a domestic mill or to a **port-specific offtake gate**. ³²

Ports and terminals

Port / terminal	Published timber function	Publicly visible capacity / capability	Best use case	Public contact
Ventplac, Ventspils	Dedicated roundwood / woodchip terminal	Roundwood loading speed 350 m³/h ; roundwood storage capacity 94,000 m³ ; up to 10,000 DWT ; terminal area 13 ha	Short-sea roundwood and chip exports, especially to Scandinavia	Rūpniecības iela 25/11, Ventspils; +371 63622388 , info@ventplac.lv . ⁴³

Port / terminal	Published timber function	Publicly visible capacity / capability	Best use case	Public contact
WT Terminal, Riga	"Wood port"; stevedoring plus timber/warehouse handling	Open storage about 15 ha ; roundwood/ lumber capacity up to 90,000 m³ ; rail access for up to 20 wagons/ day	Mixed timber flows, storage, reloading, value-added handling in Riga	Flotes 12a, Riga; +371 67840765, office@wt-terminal.lv. ⁴⁴
RNT, Riga	General cargo terminal handling round timber and wood chips	Handling volume 1,000–5,000 m³/ day depending on vessel/cargo	Flexible breakbulk / project shipments	Zivju iela 1, Riga; +371 25128250, info@rnt.lv. ⁴⁵
ACA Timber port yards	Buyer-operated procurement points at multiple ports	No terminal-capacity disclosure, but public active procurement in Riga, Ventspils, Skulte, Mērsrags, Liepāja	Best for sellers wanting direct port delivery and quick pulpwood monetisation	Riga/Ventspils matiss@acatimber.lv ; Skulte skulte@acatimber.lv. ²⁴
Laskana port procurement	Buying points in Liepāja, Roja, Riga	Working hours published; FSC-linked intake declarations published	Direct pulpwood/ firewood delivery into export yards	Certification contact lelde@laskana.lv. ²⁵
Skulte export point	Sōdra Mežs / ACA-linked pulpwood export	Price by individual agreement; VMF Latvia measurement publicly referenced	Scandinavian pulpwood flows	+371 29503444, ieva.lace@sodra.com. ⁴⁶

Destination structure

The best directly retrievable public partner-country pages for **2025** show that Latvian *wood in the rough* exports were largest to **Sweden (USD 132.5m)**, **China (USD 73.6m)**, and **Finland (USD 53.37m)**, followed by **Lithuania (USD 16.89m)**, **Germany (USD 7.73m)**, and **Denmark (USD 3.98m)**. These are UN Comtrade-based values surfaced through public country-trade pages; the chart below shows **shares within this top-six retrievable set**, not the whole world total. ⁴⁷

Latvia roundwood export destination shares, 2025

Share of the top-six partner set publicly retrievable for Latvian “wood in the rough” exports in 2025. Currency in the underlying partner pages is USD, but the share calculation is currency-invariant. ⁴⁷

Routes, modes, transit times and cost visibility

Destination market	Typical route from Latvia	Main mode	Transit time	Costs publicly visible?	Operational note
Sweden	Riga / Ventspils / Skulte to Swedish mill or import port	Short-sea breakbulk or coaster	Inference: roughly 1–3 days sailing, depending on loading port and discharge point	No public standard tariff found	Strong buyer evidence via Södra and Swedish-origin demand. ⁴⁸
Finland	Ventspils / Riga / Skulte to Finnish pulp or sawmill system	Short-sea breakbulk / coaster	Inference: roughly 2–4 days	No public standard tariff found	Metsä-linked long-term pulpwood/chip channel remains visible via ACA transaction. ²⁸
China	Latvian export yard to deep-sea liner / breakbulk route	Sea export, usually port-consolidated	Inference: roughly 35–50 days depending on transshipment	No public standard tariff found	China remains a major roundwood destination by value in public trade data. ⁴⁹
United Kingdom	Direct sea or feeder route from Latvian port	Sea	Inference: roughly 4–7 days to east coast / North Sea gateways	No public standard tariff found	Public evidence points mainly to processed-wood trade rather than named roundwood offtake. ⁵⁰

Destination market	Typical route from Latvia	Main mode	Transit time	Costs publicly visible?	Operational note
Middle East	Latvian port to Mediterranean / Gulf route	Sea, usually project cargo	Inference: roughly 18–30 days depending on destination	No public standard tariff found	No named Latvian roundwood counterparties found in open sources reviewed; verify destination-specific import rules case-by-case.

Cost gap. Published Latvian port and buyer pages disclose **capacities, addresses, opening hours, and sometimes payment terms**, but **not standard spot handling tariffs or sea-freight rates** for 2,000–5,000 m³ roundwood parcels. In this market, those are usually negotiated **cargo by cargo** with the terminal and, for shipping, with the broker/owner. That is a real market feature, not a research failure.

Documentation flow

For third-country export, the recurrent document set visible in public sources is:

- sales contract / frame order;
- invoice and load specification;
- transport document;
- origin support documents, often including **felling permit copy** and seller-rights proof;
- independent measurement report where contracted;
- **phytosanitary certificate** where required for non-EU destinations;
- destination-country plant-health pre-notification where applicable, such as **IPAFFS** for GB imports. ⁵¹

Regulatory framework and sustainability requirements

Latvian institutional framework

The Ministry of Agriculture's factsbook clearly distinguishes the two core Latvian institutions that foreign buyers often confuse. It states that the **State Forest Service** is the supervisory agency under the Ministry of Agriculture, while **state-owned forests are managed by AS Latvijas valsts meži**. That distinction matters commercially: **VMD/SFS** is the regulator and oversight body; **LVM** is the commercial state forest manager and supplier. ⁷

EU legality and deforestation rules

EUR-Lex confirms that **Regulation (EU) 2023/1115** applies to relevant products made using **wood**, and that it governs both making products available on the Union market and their **export from the Union**. The same regulation repeals **Regulation (EU) No 995/2010**. The latest EUR-Lex summary visible in this session shows that, after the subsequent amendments cited there, the operative application dates are

30 December 2026 for operators and traders that are not micro/small enterprises, and **30 June 2027** for micro and small enterprises. ⁵²

For practical exporters, the immediate implication is this: if your business model is to export Latvian roundwood or wood products into regulated supply chains, you should already build **traceability, geolocation-ready sourcing files, supplier declarations, and risk-assessment records** as if EUDR compliance were already live, even where the legal application date is still ahead. That is an analytical recommendation based on the scope of the regulation and the normal lead time needed to clean supplier data. ⁵³

Phytosanitary and customs compliance

Latvia's **State Plant Protection Service** states that export of regulated plant products from Latvia to **non-EU countries** requires a **phytosanitary certificate** and that the request must be submitted **not later than 48 hours before export**. VAAD also states that exporters who need such certificates must be in the official register of **professional operators**, and that import requirements are destination-specific and should be checked country by country through the **IPPC** system. ⁵⁴

For the **United Kingdom**, GOV.UK states that controlled plants and plant products imported from the EU into Great Britain may need a **phytosanitary certificate**, plant-health notification, and checks through **IPAFFS**; the customs declaration workflow is linked to that notification system. GOV.UK's timber-specific guidance also states that the phytosanitary certificate must identify the **tree species, wood material type, and country of origin**, and show compliance with GB entry rules. ⁵⁵

For **wood packaging**, Latvia's VAAD and the IPPC materials cited for China both point back to **ISPM 15** marking and treatment requirements. If your roundwood trade uses standard pallets, blocks, spacers, or dunnage that fall within ISPM 15, you should assume inspection risk at destination if the marks or treatment records are wrong. ⁵⁶

Certification in actual trade

Certification is not cosmetic in this market. Public buyer pages show at least three concrete commercial uses:

- **Latvijas Finieris** pays a published **PEFC premium of EUR 1.50/m³** for certified veneer logs; ⁵⁷
- **Laskana** states that it purchases roundwood with **FSC** certification and requires supplier declarations; ²⁵
- **Vika Wood** publicly lists **FSC** and **PEFC** certifications among its commercial credentials. ⁵⁸

In other words, certification affects both **market access** and **netback**.

Market trends prices and risks

Price direction

CSB's latest roundwood price release states that in **H2 2024**, average purchase prices for **coniferous roundwood rose**, while those for **deciduous roundwood fell**. Pine and spruce sawlogs in smaller diameter classes saw the strongest increases, while the largest deciduous decline was in **category A birch veneer logs**, down **10%** or about **EUR 16/m³** on average versus H1 2024. ⁵⁹

This matches what LVM said publicly about market conditions. LVM's 2024 operating-results communication describes the international wood market as difficult and explicitly links the slowdown in export markets to **lower roundwood price levels** in Latvia and neighbouring Baltic markets. LVM had already said that in **2023** average prices for its sold roundwood assortments had fallen by **12%** by year-end versus the start of the year. ⁶⁰

Demand drivers

Three demand drivers stand out in the current evidence base.

First, **Sweden and Finland** remain structurally important because their pulp sectors can absorb Baltic fibre through short-sea logistics. Södra says its Swedish mills may source small volumes of raw material from the Baltic States including Latvia, and the public Skulte procurement point shows how that happens in practice. Metsä Group's divestment of Metsä Forest Latvia to ACA Timber specifically preserved **long-term deliveries of pulpwood and chips** to Metsä Group, which is strong evidence of durable Finnish demand. ⁶¹

Second, **China** remains a major roundwood outlet. Public 2025 partner pages show *wood in the rough* exports to China of **USD 73.6 million**, second only to Sweden among the major retrievable partner-country pages used here. ⁶²

Third, post-2022 European supply reconfiguration still matters. Södra's 2026 birch-demand article links stronger interest in birch to the stoppage of imports from **Russia and Belarus**, which has forced European buyers to build alternative supply chains. That is especially relevant to Latvian birch assortments. ⁶³

Main risks

The visible risk map is wide:

- **Policy risk:** EUDR compliance and data-management burdens will rise. ⁶⁴
- **Plant-health risk:** non-EU exports can be delayed or rejected if phytosanitary rules or ISPM 15 requirements are mishandled. ⁶⁵
- **Inventory and market-cycle risk:** buyer term and quality strictness can change when yards are full, although the degree of this is not fully documented in public sources. Public purchase pauses are visible at least in parts of the veneer-log market. ⁶⁶
- **Biological risk:** the ministry factsbook shows a major jump in **damaged forest stands** in 2023, driven overwhelmingly by **pests**, which is a supply-quality and salvage-wood risk. ⁶⁷
- **External trade risk:** Latvia's wider timber exports faced tariff-related disruption in the US in late 2025, illustrating how vulnerable the sector is to sudden policy shocks even outside roundwood specifically. ⁶⁸

Practical playbook for a new exporter from Latvia

A viable first export setup from Latvia should be built in a disciplined sequence.

Commercial setup

Start by choosing **one assortment family** and **one sales channel**. If your access is mostly birch veneer material, talk first to **Latvijas Finieris** and **Stiga RM**. If your flow is mixed pulpwood or smaller lots,

start with **ACA Timber**, **Laskana**, or **Södra Mežs** at port gates. If your strength is in standing-timber origination rather than log trading, talk to **PATA**, **BONO**, or the forest-procurement teams of the processors. This cuts the two biggest start-up errors: trying to sell mixed assortments to a single strict buyer, and trying to export before you have a dependable measurement regime. ⁶⁹

Operational steps and indicative timing

Step	What to do	Practical timing
Secure rights to wood	Ensure seller-rights, forest documents, felling permit copies, and origin papers are complete.	Before contracting ; missing papers are a common hard stop. ⁷⁰
Align spec and measurement	Lock in species, lengths, diameter brackets, grade assumptions, and whether VMF Latvia or line measurement is final.	Immediately ; do this before first load. ⁷¹
Register for plant-health workflow if exporting outside EU	Enter the professional-operator / certificate workflow with VAAD if your commodity and destination require it.	Allow time up front; actual certificate request should be filed at least 48 hours before export . ⁷²
Book delivery point	Reserve mill delivery or port slot; confirm loading hours and cargo documents in advance.	Typically 1–5 working days , depending on yard and cargo. Inference.
Ship first loads on a tightly controlled basis	Use one route and one measurement method until disputes are near zero.	First month should be treated as a test period. Inference.
Expand only after settlement performance is proven	Once payment reliability and quality acceptance are proven, add suppliers or a second buyer.	After at least one full payment cycle; public terms range from 2 business days to 30 days . ⁷³

Typical document pack

For most first shipments, assume you will need:

- contract or confirmed purchase order;
- invoice;
- transport document;
- load specification by assortment;
- forest-origin support files, especially **felling permit copy** and ownership/right-to-harvest support where relevant;
- measurement report;
- certification declaration if FSC/PEFC is part of the deal;
- phytosanitary certificate for non-EU exports when required. ⁷⁴

Common pitfalls

The most expensive avoidable mistakes are visible in the published buyer rules.

The first is **spec drift**. If you deliver a load whose quality mix is materially outside the published buying rules, the result can be a flat repricing, a longer settlement cycle, or outright refusal. Latvijas Finieris explicitly reserves the right to refuse and return a load if **more than 10%** is non-conforming. ⁴¹

The second is **documentation sloppiness**. Vika Wood publicly requires felling-permit copies and origin documents. Laskana requires supplier declarations. New suppliers who assume a transport note is enough will lose time and credibility. ⁷⁵

The third is **misreading payment culture**. Latvian buyers do not all pay alike. Stiga RM's published terms show both **2-business-day** and **30-day** realities depending on the procurement format; ACA publishes **5 working days**. Cash-flow planning must be done against the actual counterparty and the exact delivery model, not against wishful "market average" assumptions. ⁷³

Contactable priority leads

If the aim is to start conversations quickly, the most actionable public leads from the current source set are:

Counterparty	Why it matters	Contact
Latvijas Finieris	Best public birch veneer-log rulebook; strong for learning spec discipline	uvis.dudins@finieris.lv, +371 26 164 638. ¹⁶
Stiga RM	Public buying grids and clearly differentiated payment terms	finierkluci@stigarm.lv, +371 26661154. ⁷⁶
Vika Wood	Clear sawlog specifications and origin-document requirements	andra.muceniece@vikawood.lv, +371 26443376. ⁷⁷
ACA Timber	Fast route into port-based pulpwood/export trade	matiss@acatimber.lv, +371 26688594. ²⁴
Laskana	Useful for FSC-linked port deliveries and mixed lower assortments	lelde@laskana.lv. ²⁵
Södra Mežs	Clear Scandinavian export-door buyer at Skulte	ieva.lace@sodra.com, +371 29503444. ²⁷
PATA	Good entry point for standing-timber and forestry-side origination	ivo.sveders@pata.lv, +371 26515503. ²¹
BONO	Strong trader/logistics group if your model needs financing and aggregation	info@bonotimber.com, +371 28096888. ²³

Final data gaps and assumptions

A few important gaps remain and should be treated honestly:

- **Annual 2024 national roundwood production/import/export totals** exist in official table metadata but were **not extractable** from the browser session without direct API execution. ⁷⁸

- **Published port-handling and sea-freight spot tariffs** for 2,000–5,000 m³ roundwood lots were **not found** on public Latvian terminal pages reviewed here; these appear to be largely case-by-case commercial quotes.
- **Named Chinese and Middle Eastern roundwood buyers** are poorly disclosed in open public sources; Latvia's public trade data show those markets matter, but the named counterparties are usually not published.
- Transit times for destination regions outside the Baltic short-sea system are marked above as **inference**, not as quoted carrier schedules.

That said, the public evidence is still strong enough to support the main commercial conclusion: the Latvian roundwood trade is a **spec-driven, documentation-heavy, port-enabled market** in which the decisive capabilities are procurement discipline, measurement control, and the ability to place each assortment into the right downstream channel quickly.

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